Social media has distorted what being a millionaire actually means

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📋 Executive Summary

Social media conflates $1M in business revenue with being a millionaire, but after a typical 25% profit margin and taxes, it can take 5–6 years of consistent operation just to accumulate $1M in real wealth.

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- Social media has distorted what it actually means to be a millionaire
  - Businesses or creators often showcase "making a million dollars" — but this refers to **gross revenue**, not personal wealth
- A business generating $1,000,000/year in revenue is not the same as its owner having $1M
  - A typical net profit margin used in the example: **25%**
  - That leaves only $250,000 in actual profit
- Taxes must still be paid on top of that profit
  - After taxes, the real take-home is even less than $250,000
- Assuming zero business growth, it would take **5–6 years** of sustained operation just to accumulate $1M in total wealth
  - This is the figure social media implies you already have the moment your revenue hits $1M

> The core insight: revenue is vanity, profit is sanity — "millionaire" status based on revenue figures is largely a social media illusion.